

Contact & Complaints Review — Trustpilot, Reviews, Social, Forums

Date: 2 July 2026. Detail: `agent_reports/agent2a_trustpilot.md` (TP-), `agent_reports/agent2b_other_reviews.md` (REV-), `agent_reports/agent4_social_media.md` (SOC-), `agent_reports/agent3_reddit_forums.md` (RED- — note: that workstream was terminated early by the operator; its report covers only the Reddit material preserved before termination, and MSE/PistonHeads/Mumsnet/CAG/LegalBeagles remain unswept).

1. Inability to contact Hello Prima (Category E — Confirmed, repeated, first-person)

Trustpilot (`helloprima.co.uk`; 5,796 reviews, TrustScore 4.3; 456 English 1★ + 73 2★):

- **"I...googled you"** — a customer explicitly went searching the open web for Prima's contact details after buying via Confused.com (4★, 5 Nov 2024, TP-05). A second googling instance: reviewer "Vannin", Oct 2024.
- **"There's no phone number to call which is worrying"** (1★, 2 Jun 2026, TP-07).
- **"at first I couldn't find a number to actually speak to a person"** (5★, 19 Feb 2026, TP-06).
- Five separate reviews state there is "no phone number" / "couldn't find a number" (TP-06–TP-10); further recurring themes: no weekend phone cover, chatbot/WhatsApp-only routes (TP-04–TP-12, TP-17).

Google reviews on Hello Prima's own profile (REV-04–REV-09): "They do not answer the phone", "you can't even phone them", "AI phone chatbots", "utterly useless over the phone".

Historical corroboration (WB-05, WB-06): Hello Prima removed "Call us 02033189745" from its "How can I contact you?" help article between 21 Feb and 11 Sep 2024, and its main site has never had an archived /contact or /complaints page.

Why this matters: every such customer is pushed into an open-web search whose results are dominated by the broker's contact details (see `search_journey_report.md`). This is the misdirection mechanism, evidenced end-to-end.

2. "Wrong Prima" / "different Prima" evidence (Category D)

- **REV-03 (Confirmed, direct):** 5★ Google review on Hello Prima's own profile (reviewer "eleanor burnet", ~2 yrs ago): *"I initially tried to find a phone number and called a company called Prima, who advised me to search for Hello Prima. All I could find was live chat or email..."* — a customer phoned a different "Prima" while hunting for Hello Prima. The review does not identify which Prima was dialled.
- **TP-01 (Probable):** the only review on the broker's Trustpilot page (`primainsurance.co.uk`; 1★, 10 Jun 2026) reads as a motor policyholder's complaint ("refused to change [policy dates]. Charged me for changing address... Sent my proof of NCB more times than I can count") — matching Hello

Prima's 1★ pattern point-for-point. Probable misdirected review; not confirmable from public data (the broker also arranges insurance).

- **TP-20 / SOC-09 (negative, stated plainly):** across 950 Trustpilot reviews and all indexed social platforms, no post uses "wrong Prima" / "different Prima" / "another Prima" or reports dialling the broker's numbers.

3. Whose reviews surface where (Category I)

- Trustpilot's own company search for "prima insurance" returns **the broker's profile first**; Hello Prima appears seventh. For bare "prima", Hello Prima is first — the inversion happens exactly when a customer adds the word "insurance" (TP-03).
- The broker's Trustpilot profile is claimed but populated with placeholder junk ("aaa", a@gmail.com, 07891544866) — it gives a landing customer no correct broker contact details and no signal distinguishing it from Hello Prima (TP-02).
- Bing "prima insurance brokers manchester reviews" ranks **Hello Prima's Trustpilot page #1**, above the broker's own site and Feefo listing (REV-13) — misdirection runs in both directions.
- Consumers' shorthand for the insurer is the broker's name: of 950 reviews, 1 says "Hello Prima"; 17 say "Prima insurance"; 9 "Prima car insurance"; the rest "Prima" (TP-19). Trustpilot displays the insurer's business name as simply "Prima".

4. Claims routing (Category F)

- Hello Prima claims are handled by third party **Broker Direct Plc**; 1★ reviewers rail against "Prima Insurance and Broker Direct", blurring the word "broker" around the Prima brand (TP-15, TP-16; corroborated by a Mar 2025 archived review, WB-12).
- Reddit corroboration (independent platform): *"I called Prima and pressed 3 to register a non fault accident. I didn't realise but I had been put through to a third party claims management company called BD Elite"* (r/CarTalkUK, 30 Apr 2025, RED-01); a second poster: *"They tried to push me towards a 3rd party claims management company called BD Elite... pressuring me to sign a credit agreement"* (RED-03); *"Prima have literally washed their hands of it"* (RED-02).
- claimsnumber.com (an admitted independent claims-management company) publishes "Prima Car Insurance Accident Claim Contact Phone Number 0333 006 4465" — neither Prima's number (AGG-09, AI-12); prima.theclaimscentre.net (Bolton 01204 numbers) also ranks for Prima claims queries (SE-10).
- Bing's AI claims answer cites the broker's contact page as a source (AI-03).

5. Cancellation / MTA / change-car difficulty (Category H)

- Trustpilot: difficulty changing car/address, cancellation threats over document uploads (TP-13, TP-14).
- SERPs for "prima insurance cancellation" / "prima car insurance cancellation" rank the broker's Terms & Conditions #1–2, displaying "Prima Financial Services Ltd, Cancellations Department... 0330 118 0404" in the snippet (SE-05) — a Hello Prima customer trying to cancel is shown the broker's cancellations department.

6. Complaints routing (Category G)

- The only complaints phone number visible on the Bing SERP for "prima insurance complaints phone number" is the broker's **0161 826 1620**; People-also-ask reframes the query as "How do I register a complaint with Prima Financial Services Ltd?" (AI-06, SE-04).
- Regulatory context: DISP 1.7.1R (forwarding wrong-firm complaints), DISP 1.6.2R (8-week/FOS clock) — see `agent_reports/agent8_legal_regulatory.md`.

7. Platforms with nothing to report (honest negatives)

- Smart Money People, Reviews.io, Review Centre, MoneySavingExpert reviews: no listing for either business (REV-17).
- Broker's Google profile: 4 reviews, all genuinely about the broker (REV-12); broker's Facebook page: 0 reviews (SOC agent). Feefo: broker-only listings (238 reviews, all 2021–Jan 2022), publicly displaying 0161 826 1620 (REV-11).
- Public social media: no confusion posts found; login walls on X/LinkedIn/Facebook/ Instagram noted as access blockers, not evidence of absence (SOC report).

8. Access limitations

Trustpilot login wall beyond page 10 of any filtered list (evidence preserved); Yelp, Facebook reviews, Cylex, Yably bot-blocked; Google web search CAPTCHA-blocked (Google Maps accessible); Reddit native search bot-blocked (Wayback + API used). The forums workstream was terminated before sweeping MSE, PistonHeads, Mumsnet, CAG, LegalBeagles and AVForums — those remain unchecked (RED-05).